

Hannah Denker

Updated: September 3, 2026

University of Arkansas

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EDUCATION

Ph.D., Research and Evaluation Methodology, University of Colorado Boulder 2023

Dissertation: “Exploring Structural Features and Classroom Processes in Early Childhood Education: An Examination of Time Use, Quality, and Teacher Wages”

Committee: Mimi Engel (chair), Allison Atteberry, Ben Shear, Oded Gurantz, and Karl Hill

M.S., Educational Technology, Oklahoma State University 2013

B.S. (*Summa Cum Laude*), Elementary Education, Oklahoma State University 2011

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Research Assistant Professor, College of Education and Health Professions, *University of Arkansas* 2024–Present

Postdoctoral Research Associate, School of Education and Human Development, *University of Virginia* 2023–2024

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, *Lyons Assessment Consulting*, Dr. Susan Lyons 2022–2024

PEER-REVIEWED JOURNAL ARTICLES

1. **Denker, H. K.**, Markowitz, A. J., and Bassok, D. (2026). “Supporting newly hired child care teachers: The role of onboarding.” *Early Childhood Research Quarterly*, 76, 217–229. [\[DOI\]](#)
2. Steeger, C. M., Combs, K. M., Racz, S. J., Brooks-Russell, A., Lain, M. A., Drewelow, K. M., Zaugg, S., **Denker, H. K.**, and Hill, K. G. (2026). “Effectiveness of the Botvin High School LifeSkills Training intervention on adolescent substance use: A cluster randomized trial.” *Journal of Adolescent Health*, 79(1), 144–153. [\[DOI\]](#)
3. **Denker, H. K.** and Atteberry, A. C. (2024). “Where has all the time gone? Describing time use in full- vs. half-day pre-Kindergarten.” *Early Childhood Research Quarterly*, 68, 235–246. [\[DOI\]](#)

BOOK CHAPTERS

1. Airola, D., **Denker, H. K.**, and McKenzie, S. (2026, forthcoming). “Context of Arkansas.” In H. A. Patrinos and K. Scott (Eds.), *The State of Education in Arkansas* (pp. 19–26). University of Arkansas Press.
2. Engel, M., Shaw Attaway, D., and **Denker, H. K.** (2025). “Curricula in early childhood education preschool settings.” In L. Cohen-Vogel, P. Youngs, and J. Scott (Eds.), *Handbook of Education Policy Research* (2nd ed., pp. 959–984). American Educational Research Association. [\[DOI\]](#)

PUBLIC-FACING RESEARCH BRIEFS AND REPORTS

1. Shaw, K., McKenzie, S., Zamarro, G., and **Denker, H. K.** (2026). “Teacher attendance in Arkansas public schools: Trends and workforce differences.” *Arkansas Education Report*, 23(5). Office for Education Policy, University of Arkansas.
2. **Denker, H. K.** (2026). “Connecting ECE quality measures to later outcomes: Evaluating alignment between Arkansas’s early care and education quality measures and later child outcomes.” *Arkansas Education Report*, 23(2). Office for Education Policy, University of Arkansas.
3. **Denker, H. K.** (2025). “Arkansas early care and education key performance indicators: Baseline report.” *Arkansas Education Report*, 22(4). Office for Education Policy, University of Arkansas.
4. **Denker, H. K.** (2025). “Arkansas School Readiness Assistance program: Fall 2025 policy changes–impact assessment.” Office for Education Policy, University of Arkansas.
5. **Denker, H. K.** (2025). “Arkansas ECCE funding report: Federal and state programs.” *Arkansas Education Report*, 22(1). Office for Education Policy, University of Arkansas.
6. **Denker, H. K.**, Fares, I., Michie, M., and Bassok, D. 2024. “Changes in early educator turnover in 2021-2022 and 2022-2023: Evidence from a fixed sample of Virginia sites.” Study of Early Education through Partnerships, University of Virginia.
7. **Denker, H. K.**, Fares, I., Michie, M., and Bassok, D. 2024. “Turnover rates among Virginia’s early educators: New evidence from 2022-2023.” Study of Early Education through Partnerships, University of Virginia.
8. **Denker, H. K.**, Fares, I., and Bassok, D. 2024. “One- and two-year retention among Virginia’s early educators.” Study of Early Education through Partnerships, University of Virginia.

SELECTED PUBLIC SCHOLARSHIP

1. **Denker, H. K.** (2025). “Early child care–Part 1: What’s behind Arkansas’s School Readiness Assistance child care subsidies?” Office for Education Policy, University of Arkansas.
2. **Denker, H. K.** (2025). “Early child care–Part 2: What the new SRA rules actually mean for children, families, and providers.” Office for Education Policy, University of Arkansas.
3. **Denker, H. K.** (2025). “Don’t leave working Arkansas families behind: What’s at stake with proposed Head Start cuts.” Office for Education Policy, University of Arkansas.
4. **Denker, H. K.** (2025). “Supporting Arkansas’s early childhood workforce: Progress, challenges, and what’s next.” Office for Education Policy, University of Arkansas.

SELECTED WORKS IN PROGRESS

1. **Denker, H. K.**, Chen-Doromal, J., and Bassok, D. “Wages and staffing outcomes in Virginia child care centers.”
2. **Denker, H. K.** and Butts, K. “Choosing early: Patterns of school choice and stability in the first years of schooling.”
3. **Denker, H. K.** and Atteberry, A. C. “(Mis)measuring pre-Kindergarten classroom characteristics.”
4. **Denker, H. K.** “A degree of change: How credentialing policies affect wages and employment in pre-K education.”

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Colorado Boulder

Psychological Science II: Research Methods in Psychology (<i>Undergraduate</i>)	2023
Teaching Assistant for Multilevel Modeling (<i>Ph.D.</i>)	2022
Teaching Assistant for Quantitative Methods II (<i>Ph.D.</i>)	2020
School of Education: Summer Math and Data Course (<i>Ph.D.</i>)	2020

Oklahoma State University

Applications of Educational Technologies (<i>Undergraduate</i>)	2011–2013
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K-12

Elementary Classroom Teacher	2013–2017
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ACADEMIC RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Understanding the Effects of Financial Bonuses on Child Care Staff Retention (RCT) <i>Research Assistant for Dr. Allison Atteberry</i>	2022–2023
High School LifeSkills Training Study (RCT) <i>Research Assistant for Dr. Karl Hill</i>	2021–2022
Westminster Public Schools Full-Day Pre-K Study (RCT) <i>Research Assistant for Dr. Allison Atteberry</i>	2020–2020
The Effects of Pre-K Curricula on Outcomes <i>Research Assistant for Dr. Mimi Engel</i>	2017–2021
Replication and Robustness in Quantitative Education Research <i>Research Assistant for Dr. Mimi Engel</i>	2019–2020
Variation in Early Mathematics Instruction Across Grades and Schools in NYC <i>Research Assistant for Dr. Mimi Engel</i>	2018–2019
Professional Education Unit, Oklahoma State University <i>Research Assistant for Dr. Susan Stansberry</i>	2011–2013

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Presenting author for all listed presentations.

1. **Denker, H. K.**, Doromal, J., and Bassok, D. (2026, March). “Wages and staffing outcomes in Virginia child care centers.” Association for Education Finance and Policy Annual Conference, Chicago, IL.
2. **Denker, H. K.** and Butts, K. (2026, January). “Choosing early: Patterns of school choice and stability in the first years of schooling.” International School Choice and Reform Conference, Rome, Italy.
3. **Denker, H. K.**, Bassok, D., and Markowitz, A. J. (2024, March). “Child care worker onboarding practices and their relationship with perceived preparation, efficacy, job satisfaction, and commitment.” Association for Education Finance and Policy Annual Conference, Washington, DC.

4. **Denker, H. K.** and Atteberry, A. C. (2023, March). “(Mis)Measuring pre-kindergarten classroom characteristics.” Association for Education Finance and Policy Annual Conference, Denver, CO.
5. Lyons, S., Hinds, B. F., **Denker, H. K.**, and Student, S. (2022, October). “A framework for culturally responsive assessment development.” Consortium for Research on Educational Assessment and Teaching Effectiveness (CREATE) Annual Conference, Asheville, NC.
6. **Denker, H. K.**, Atteberry, A. C., and Engel, M. (2019, November). “And then comes testing: How schools reallocate classroom time when high-stakes testing begins in 3rd grade.” Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management Fall Research Conference, Denver, CO.
7. **Denker, H. K.**, Bassok, D., Engel, M., and Atteberry, A. C. (2019, March). “Comparing academic time use across second and third grades.” Association for Education Finance and Policy Annual Conference, Kansas City, MO.

INVITED TALKS AND POLICY PRESENTATIONS

1. **Denker, H. K.** (2026, January). “Wages and staffing outcomes in Virginia child care centers.” Strengthening Quality Core Team, Virginia Department of Education.
2. **Denker, H. K.** (2025, November). “Tracking access, quality, and workforce indicators in Arkansas early care and education.” Department of Education Reform and Office for Education Policy Fall Conference, Little Rock, AR.
3. **Denker, H. K.** (2025, November). “Using CLASS to support quality improvement in Arkansas early care and education.” Department of Education Reform and Office for Education Policy Fall Conference, Little Rock, AR.
4. **Denker, H. K.** (2025, November). “Economics of early childhood care and education in Arkansas.” Invited plenary panelist, Economics of Early Childhood Care and Education Initiative Convening, Bentonville, AR.
5. **Denker, H. K.** (2025, January). “Early childhood education funding findings in Arkansas.” Arkansas Office of Early Childhood Leadership Meeting.
6. **Denker, H. K.** and Daniel, A. (2024, December). “Early childhood education: Licensing and funding in Arkansas.” Office for Education Policy Annual Conference, Little Rock, AR.

MEDIA MENTIONS

- Morano, M. (2026, July 11). Arkansas daycare providers reducing services, shutting doors 8 months after state funding cuts. *Arkansas Democrat-Gazette*. <https://www.arkansasonline.com/news/2026/jul/11/arkansas-daycare-providers-reducing-services/>

RESEARCH AND POLICY ENGAGEMENT

- Guiding Team Member, Early Childhood Governance and Finance Project, Forward Arkansas (2026–Present)
- Member, Arkansas Early Childhood Indicators Workgroup, Arkansas Department of Education Office of Early Childhood and Foresight Law + Policy (2026–Present)

PROFESSIONAL SERVICES

Journal Reviewer (Ad-Hoc)

- Early Childhood Research Quarterly, Education Researcher

Conference Proposal Reviewer

- Association for Education Finance and Policy (2025)
- American Educational Research Association (2025)

Mentoring

- Faculty Mentor, Xueshen Shi and Kim Shaw, University of Arkansas (2025–Present)
- Faculty Mentor, Rachel Saulsbery, University of Arkansas (2025)
- Mentor, University of Virginia Undergraduate Education Policy Associates (2023–2024)
- Mentor, University of Colorado Boulder STUDIO Undergraduate Research Program (2021-2023)

University Service

- Member, Off-Campus Duty Assignment Application Review Committee, College of Education and Health Professions, University of Arkansas (2025–Present)
- Member, Student Association for Graduate Educators (SAGE), University of Colorado Boulder (2018-2019)